Practice workbook · Human language vs animal communication

Aitchison's language criteria and how human communication compares with animal signals.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-LAN-03

1. Question 39 · part whole · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

39 Harry was planning to take his dog, Betty, for a walk, but it was raining. He told Betty that they would go for a walk in the woods when the rain stopped. Harry said they could look for a big stick for her to play with, and maybe they would see some squirrels. Betty wagged her tail while Harry spoke to her.

Explain **one** reason why Betty would not understand Harry's plan for the walk.

You must use Aitchison (1983) to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 39 = 2 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

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Working and answer

2. Question 38 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

38 Describe **one** feature of communication that is used only by humans and not naturally by animals.

(Total for Question 38 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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3. Question 36 · part whole · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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36 Describe **one** similarity between human and animal communication.

(Total for Question 36 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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4. Question 41 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

41 Emily has a pet dog called Terry. When she comes home, she likes to talk to Terry about her day at work and he responds by wagging his tail. Terry makes a whining noise when he wants to sit next to Emily on the sofa, and he uses his paw to get Emily's attention. When Emily uses the word 'walkies', Terry barks and runs to the front door of the house.

Explain **one** similarity and **one** difference between the communication of Emily and her dog.

You must refer to concepts or theory to justify your answer.

Similarity

Difference

(Total for Question 41 = 4 marks)

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4. Question 41 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 37 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

37 Angela and Missy were having a conversation about their plans for their future.

Angela:	*I want to be a lawyer so I will need to go to university.*
Missy:	*I am not sure what I want to be, but I definitely plan to go to university.*
Angela:	*We would have so much fun! Can you imagine if we lived together?*
Missy:	*That would be so cool! We could have a house with a 200-inch TV!*
Angela:	*Like a cinema house!!*

Explain, using Aitchison (1983), **one** way that Angela and Missy's communication is different from how animals communicate.

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(Total for Question 37 = 2 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Working and answer

6. Question 34 · part whole · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

34 Identify which feature of language (Aitchison, 1983) is common to both human and animal communication.

- ☒ **A** Turn-taking
- ☒ **B** Structure dependence
- ☒ **C** Displacement
- ☒ **D** Semanticity

(Total for Question 34 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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